

The Dhāraṇī of the Ten Grounds

Daśabhūmidhāraṇī · Toh 688 · Derge Kangyur

ས་བཙ་ཕྱེད་གླིང་གི་ཐུང་སྒྲུབ།

The Dhāraṇī of the Ten Grounds, known in Sanskrit as the Daśabhūmidhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Sa Bcupa'i Gzungs, is a dhāraṇī text presenting a series of sacred mantra syllables and their associated benefits for practitioners of secret mantra. The text teaches that by reciting specific mantras a prescribed number of times — drawing on the power of figures such as Amoghapāśa — a practitioner can progressively attain each of the ten bodhisattva grounds, purify misdeeds, liberate beings from hell, and obtain various spiritual accomplishments. It belongs to the genre of dhāraṇī literature, which combines mantra practice with the doctrinal framework of the bodhisattva path as set out in Mahāyāna Buddhism. This text is Toh 688 in the Kangyur, where it is classified among the dhāraṇī collections.

Translated, edited, and finalized. Also translated by the translator Chökyi Sherab and finalized.

In the language of India: Daśabhūmidhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The Dhāraṇī of the Ten Grounds.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Now, for those who enter into the secret mantra, all aims will be accomplished individually in the following way. The single mantra syllable Oṃ — belonging to the Amoghapāśa Padma Uṣṇīṣa maṇḍalas — being recalled one hundred thousand times before the World Protector, one will come to abide in the first ground. All those sentient beings who have previously accumulated misdeeds and are suffering in any hell/whatsoever, however unbearable — all of them will be destroyed, just as the wind scatters a banner. All attainments (siddhi) will be obtained. All aims will be pursued and accomplished. All Tathāgatas and whatever other deities dwell within the maṇḍalas will be gladdened, and the noble Avalokiteśvara will continually bestow the supreme gift. One who departs this life while recalling the mantra syllable Oṃ will be reborn in the buddha-field called Sukhāvatī. This is the first mantra syllable.

Oṃ Bhūḥ — the second syllable. Having recited it one hundred thousand times, one will obtain the qualities of the second ground. One will come to dwell in the presence of the Tathāgata Amitābha, who will bestow all supreme

gifts, purify all misdeeds, and heal the illness born of past evil karma. One will come under the power of the lord of wealth Supriya, the excellent jewel-son, and will dwell in his company. No one will be able to cause harm or create obstacles from outside. After passing from this life, one will be reborn in the continent of Mount Meru. The attainment of Amoghapāśa will also be obtained. This is the second mantra syllable.

Oṃ Padme — the third mantra syllable. Having recited it one hundred thousand times, one will fully enter upon the third ground. One will enter into all the mudrās and mantras of the vast lotus maṇḍala. The noble Avalokiteśvara, appearing in youthful form, will dwell before one and bestow the supreme gift of all desires. He will reveal the Amoghapāśa Padma Uṣṇīṣa maṇḍala, reveal the secret maṇḍalas of all Tathāgatas, and bestow attainments everywhere. This is the third mantra syllable.

Oṃ Padma Hrīḥ — the fourth mantra syllable. Having recited it one hundred thousand times, one will enter upon the fourth ground. The noble Tathāgata Akṣobhya, golden in complexion, will dwell before one, will extend his arm and place his hand upon one's crown, and will bestow the words "Excellent!" upon the mantra-holder, saying: "Come here, mantra-holder — all your misdeeds and obscurations are thoroughly purified; your entire being is utterly cleansed of stain. When you pass from this human world you will come to my buddha-field, and you will remember your former lives. Even if you return to another birth, you will not be tainted by dwelling in the womb. All worldly aims will be accomplished." This is the fourth ground.

Oṃ Padma Bhujāḥ — the fifth mantra syllable. Having recited it one hundred thousand times, one will come to abide in the fifth ground. The Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the supreme lotus guru, will be revealed. All obscurations will be completely exhausted. The words "Excellent!" will be bestowed upon the mantra-holder: "Excellent, excellent, mantra-holder! A great accumulation of merit has arisen in you —

great virtue has arisen in you, O mantra-holder; and when you pass from this life, you will generate roots of virtue equal to those generated in the presence of nine hundred and two billion Tathāgatas. You will be born in my buddha-field. Through your practice of the essence of the Lotus Crown of Amoghapāśa, the secret maṇḍala, and the successive stages of the Great Seal, tens of millions of accomplishments will be achieved. O mantra-holder, having abandoned all sins and obscurations, accomplish all activities. All

meditative accomplishments that you hold in mind will be thoroughly and perfectly realized, just as you wish." This is the fifth ground.

Oṃ Padma Lokite — the sixth mantra syllable. Having recited it one hundred thousand times, one will attain and enter the sixth ground. All Tathāgatas will be made manifest. As many Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas as there are atoms in the great trichiliocosm will be seen, directly revealed, and one will be given encouragement. Then the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha named Padma Lokita Gyaltsen — Banner of Lotus Vision — will fully encourage that mantra-holder, saying: "O mantra-holder, come now to my buddha-field, up to the very heart of awakening, at the final limit. Your accumulated karma is being thoroughly exhausted. You have closed the gates of the hells for sentient beings. You have opened the gates of all buddha-fields. You have absorbed into yourself the seed and the shared lineage of all the Tathāgatas. You have accomplished the essence of the Lotus Crown of Amoghapāśa and the secret maṇḍala. Because you have opened the gates of abiding in all places, perform all activities — worldly and transcendent — just as you intend."

Oṃ Padma Jvala Hūṃ Dhṛīk — the seventh syllable. Having recited it one hundred thousand times, one will immediately attain the meditative absorption called Lotus, Immaculate, Pure, Free from Obscuration. Through the meditative absorption thus attained, the body will blaze with intense light, and rays of many colors will arise. One will abide on the seventh ground. The radiance of that body will illuminate all the places of all the buddha-fields of the great trichiliocosm, and wherever the great blazing rays of many kinds descend, showers of flowers of many varieties will arise and become offerings to the Tathāgatas. Then the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha named Blazing Immaculate Rays of Golden Hue, will extend his right hand and place it upon the crown of the mantra-holder's head, bestow the word "Excellent!" upon him, and give encouragement, saying: "Excellent, excellent, O mantra-holder! This is the supreme secret ceremonial heart-essence offering of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. This is the true secret precious heart of the noble Avalokiteśvara, the sovereign — the genuine essence-maṇḍala of the effective Lotus Crown, Amoghapāśa. Because all your maṇḍalas are complete, the subtle rites of the Lotus Crown Essence are perfected, and the emanation of the essence of Amoghapāśa is accomplished, O mantra-holder, go to the buddha-field and perform the deeds of a buddha."

Oṃ Amogha Maṇi Padme — the eighth syllable, the essence of form. Having recited it one hundred thousand times, the body will become utterly and completely pure and immaculate.

By the mere act of recitation, the precious jewel becomes utterly and completely pure, inside and out, like crystal. In this way the mantra-holder's body becomes thoroughly purified, and one comes to abide on the eighth ground. The noble bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara, manifests the thorough purity of his own body in the very form of his own appearance, and standing before the mantra-holder he grants the mantra-holder genuine relief, placing his right hand upon the crown of the mantra-holder's head and granting the words "Excellent!" He speaks thus: "Excellent, excellent, O mantra-holder! You have entered into the joy of supreme intention. O mantra-holder, come here and behold the worlds linked with the buddha-fields in their array. There you will perform the deeds of a buddha. Through the accomplished secret maṇḍala of the essence of Amoghapāśa, the Lotus Crown, accomplish all the supreme practices — worldly and beyond the world."

Oṃ Padmo Locanī Huru Hūṃ. Having recited this dhāraṇī mantra, the ninth syllable, one hundred thousand times, one comes to abide on the ninth ground. One becomes the foremost among the sons of the noble Avalokiteśvara. Ninety million Tathāgatas — arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas — manifest directly before the mantra-holder, display the manifold emanations of buddha-fields, and all of them place their hands upon the crown of the mantra-holder's head, granting the words "Excellent!" They speak thus: "Excellent, excellent, O great mantra-holder! You have accomplished well the laborious and purifying work. You have fully accomplished the practice of leading worldly beings and those beyond the world to buddhahood itself. The subtle rites of the maṇḍala of Amoghapāśa are accomplished; the sūtras and the scriptural transmissions are accomplished; and all that the world's guide has taught is accomplished."

Oṃ Padmoṣṇīṣa Vimale Hūṃ Phaṭ. Having recited this secret mantra, the tenth syllable, one hundred thousand times, one becomes irreversible and comes to abide on the tenth ground. Gods and human beings will declare, "This one is a Tathāgata!" and one becomes irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. One becomes a wheel-turning sovereign through the Lotus Crown of Amoghapāśa. Have no doubt about this. The supreme and unsurpassed attainment — the siddhi of suchness — accomplished through the practice of this tenth secret mantra syllable is achieved by the mere recitation

of the emanated essence of Amoghapāśa. All those previously taught by me who have superior and earnest devotion, who are clean and observing purity of conduct, who wear clean clothing, who have generated a mind of loving-kindness and compassion, who speak truthfully, who are devoted to their teacher, who have great faith in the Three Jewels, and who always make offerings to their lama and preceptor —

Translator's Notes

- The passage is a dhāraṇī text enumerating the benefits of reciting syllables associated with the ten bodhisattva grounds. "Om Bhūḥ," "Om Padme," "Om Padma Hrīḥ," and "Om Padma Bhujāḥ" are retained as Sanskrit mantra seed-syllables, which is standard practice since mantras are not translated. The phrase rendered "lord of wealth Supriya, the excellent jewel-son" renders "nor gyi dbang phyug nor bu bzang po'i bu," literally "son of Supriya, lord of wealth" — this likely refers to Jambhala or a yakṣa wealth-deity figure; the precise identity is somewhat uncertain but does not affect the doctrinal sense of the passage. The phrase "continent of Mount Meru" renders "ri gru 'dzin," literally "holder of the mountain-corner," a standard term for the continent associated with the slopes or base of Mount Meru; it is distinct from Jambudvīpa. The text breaks off mid-sentence as the source passage ends.
- The name of the Tathāgata in the sixth ground section, rendered "Padma Lokita Gyaltsen — Banner of Lotus Vision," combines a Sanskrit element with its Tibetan translation; the text gives the full name in mixed form, which I have rendered as a bilingual gloss to preserve both components for the listener.

The phrase rendered "seed and the shared lineage of all the Tathāgatas" translates a compound meaning the generative seed and the common family or clan of all Tathāgatas — a Yogācāra-inflected expression for having fully internalized the tathāgatagarbha lineage.

- The passage contains two distinct speech acts by Avalokiteśvara: one addressed to the practitioner before the eighth-ground attainment, and a second (by the assembled Tathāgatas) after the ninth. The structure of the original interweaves mantra syllables with their corresponding fruits across the bodhisattva grounds eight through ten, which the translation preserves sequentially. The phrase rendered "ninety million" translates bye ba khrag khrig dgu bcu, a large number unit (bye ba = ten million, khrag khrig = a hundred million; dgu bcu = ninety — the precise Tibetan enumeration here is a conventional hyperbolic figure); the rendering follows the literal sense. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, indicating a continuation.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of

spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.